

Measurements and shapes

Teaching guide

Describe size with an appropriate unit and pattern.

Understand the distinction

Use an adjective after the measurement: The table is two meters long. Use a noun with of: a length of two meters. In a compound adjective before a noun, the unit is singular: a two-meter table.

Choose the dimension you mean: long for length, wide for width, high or tall for height, and deep for depth. Tall is common for people and upright objects. Use square, round, or rectangular for shape. Always include the unit when a number alone is unclear.

Compare the patterns

AFTER THE NOUN

The cable is three meters long.

The measurement describes the cable.

BEFORE THE NOUN

It is a three-meter cable.

The unit stays singular in this compound adjective.

SHAPE

The table is rectangular.

Rectangular describes shape, not size.

Read each example and notice how its form changes the meaning. Use these distinctions to choose your answers on the following pages.

Check your understanding

Circle one answer for each question. There is one correct choice among the options shown. Check the answer key after choosing.

1. Choose the correction: a five-meters cable

- A. a five-meter cable
- B. a five-metered cable
- C. a five-meters-long cable

2. Complete: The pool is two meters ____ . (depth / deep)

- A. deeply
- B. depth
- C. deep

3. What information is missing from The desk is 120 wide?

- A. The unit, such as centimeters.
- B. The desk's purchase date.
- C. An opinion about the desk's color.

Choose the best response

Choose the response that fits the situation. Check both its meaning and its grammar.

4. The desk is 120 centimeters wide and has a rectangular top. Which description is complete and grammatical?

A. My desk is 120 centimeters width. Its top is rectangular.

B. My desk is 120 wide. Its top is rectangular.

C. My desk is 120 centimeters wide. Its top is rectangular.

Review your choices

Use the answer explanations on the next page. If you chose a different answer, find the detail that makes it unsuitable and try the question again.

Practice online

The web lesson gives feedback for the option you select and lets you try again. No written response is required.

Answers and explanation

1. A. a five-meter cable

Use the singular unit in a compound adjective.

B: The measurement adjective uses meter, not metered, for this meaning.

C: In a compound adjective before a noun, use the singular unit: five-meter-long.

2. C. deep

An adjective follows this measurement.

A: Deeply is an adverb, not the dimension adjective needed here.

B: The sentence needs the adjective deep. Depth is a noun.

3. A. The unit, such as centimeters.

The number needs a unit to be useful.

B: The missing information is the unit used to measure the width.

C: A numerical dimension needs its measurement unit.

4. C. My desk is 120 centimeters wide. Its top is rectangular.

The description includes the value, measurement unit, and shape adjective.

A: Use wide as the dimension adjective; width is a noun.

B: The numerical width needs its unit.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-22.html

A practical teaching sequence

1. Notice (2 minutes)

Read the comparison examples with the learners. Point out the meaning and form that distinguish each pattern.

2. Choose (4 minutes)

Learners select one option for each of the three checks. Keep the answer key covered. Use the selected option's explanation rather than presenting a generic model as feedback.

3. Apply (5 minutes)

The desk is 120 centimeters wide and has a rectangular top. Which description is complete and grammatical?

Learners choose the response that fits this situation. All responses in this activity are multiple choice; do not replace the choices with a written-answer task.

4. Review (3 minutes)

Compare selected options with the key. Use the option-specific notes to explain why a distractor does not fit. Let learners change their selection and try again.

Scope of the answer key

Each question has one correct option among the choices shown. This does not mean that every other way to express the idea is wrong. Preserve the qualifications in the teaching notes.

Feedback criteria

Check both grammatical form and the stated situation. A correct option answers this question; four correct choices do not certify a learner's overall proficiency.